30 MINUTES Target travel time for the first Avishkar Hyperloop in a 350-km Chennai–Bengaluru vacuum tube



TRANSPORT | ULTRA-HIGH-SPEED RAIL

HIGH ON THE HYPERLOOP

India is betting on student-led innovation to crack Hyperloop technology—aiming not just to catch up, but to lead the global race for next-gen high-speed mobility

By AVISHEK G. DASTIDAR

Glinting in the summer sun amid the lush green expanse of the sprawling Discovery campus at the Indian Institute of Technology Madras in Chennai is a 422-metre-long metallic tube. Inside it lies an idea, one that a team of students is developing which could hasten India's journey towards Viksit Bharat.

This is the Avishkar Hyperloop, India's most ambitious shot at joining the elite group of nations racing to make vacuum tube-based ultra-high-speed transportation a reality. It's a government-supported, academia-led effort placing young engineers at the heart of a mass-mobility experiment. Since 2022, the Modi government has pumped in over Rs 30 crore into the project, the latest tranche arriving this February. Spearheaded by the railway ministry under Ashwini Vaishnaw, the plan is to build an ultra-long Hyperloop test track of 40